

Assignment 4: Concept Video





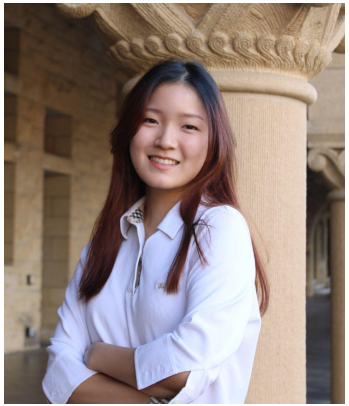
Our Team



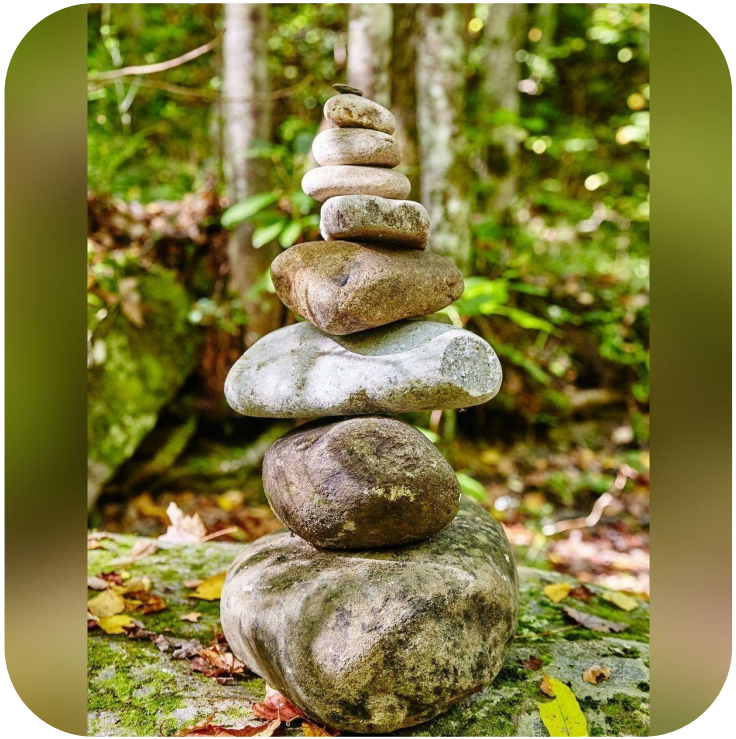
Ryan L.
CS ‘28



Brian L.
BioE ‘26, CS ‘27



Cherie C.
DataSci ‘27

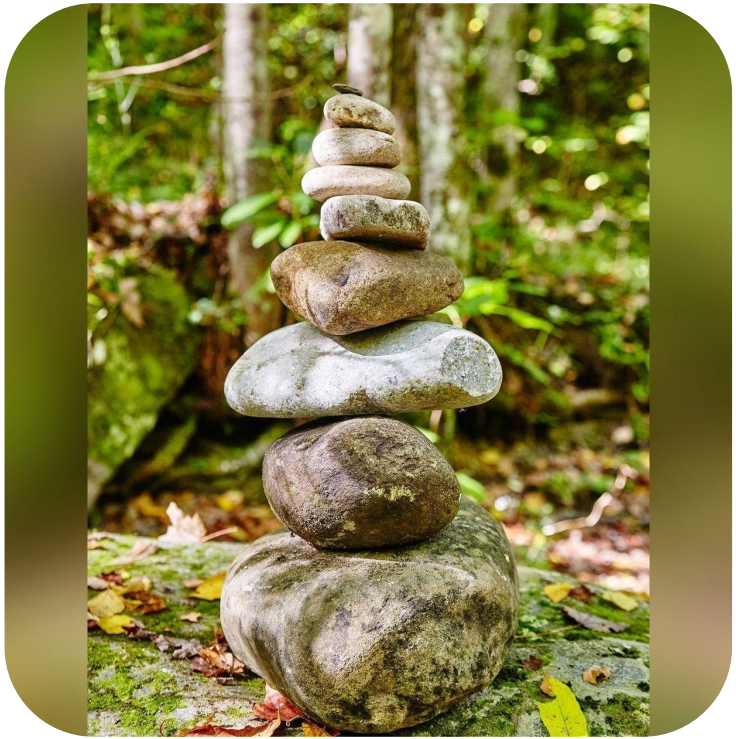


pebble.

imperfection rocks

→ We want users to slowly accumulate **imperfect** drawings until they create a greater artifact (their gallery) that is sharable with other users

→ The value proposition has a double meaning: we call user drawings “pebbles”, and since they are imperfect, they are **“imperfection rocks”**



pebble.

imperfection rocks

→ Daily 5-minute drawing prompts and platform for **busy** students and professionals with a hunger for creativity but no time

→ See **other users' drawings** for the same prompt after completion, invite friends, and reach milestones

Market Research

1. Gartic Phone
2. Dazzle
3. BeReal

What Works

-> Low skill barrier intentionally makes the product into a joke

-> Fun social activity encourage returns

-> Drawings build on each other/increases social responsibility of each user

-> Shorter sessions can allow for casual play

What Doesn't Work

-> Requires other people/not a solo activity

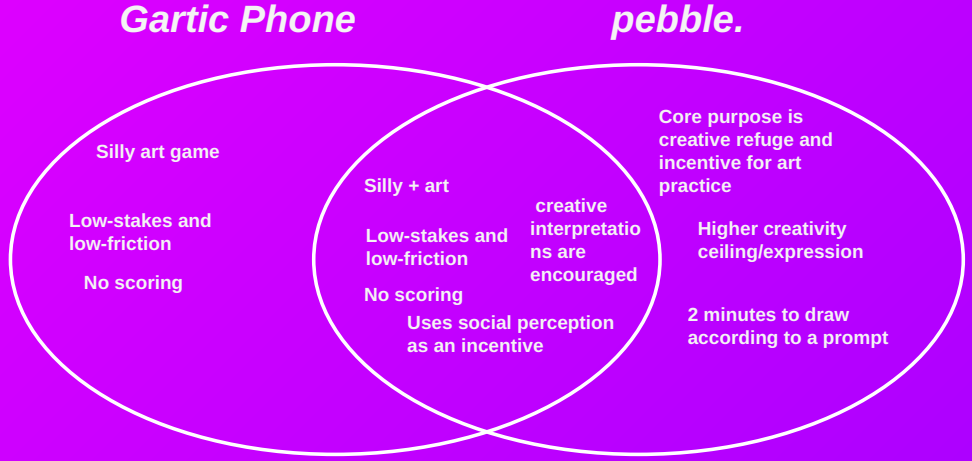
-> Temporary drawings (not automatically saved on behalf of user)

-> Longer games require time and commitment of all users

-> Lots of stimulating bells and whistles that might be intimidating to older generations

1

Gartic Phone



Implication for our Solution:

-> Fun is directly derived from friends and their participation

-> Want to keep drawings rather than toss them after game is over

-> Maintain creative interpretation of prompts



https://garticphone.com/

What Works

-> (Silver lining) very wide target demographic; anyone who is creative and has a creative block

-> Social + mobile platform and widely accessible

-> Team held to quantity over quality when evaluators pushed back

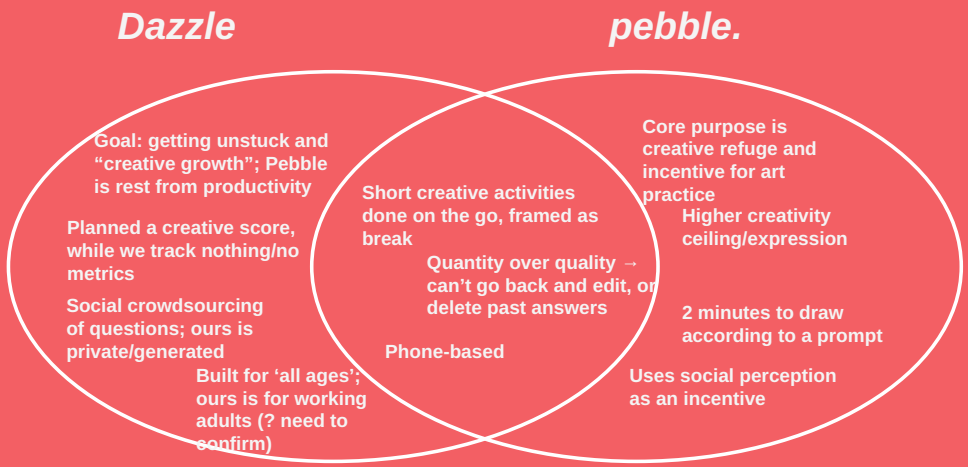
-> Most heuristic issues were quick fixes

What Doesn't Work

-> Evaluators found no directions on how to use it or start an exercise

-> At the hi-fi milestone the drawing board and speech-to-text were unbuilt, and creativity score was hard coded, meaning no algorithm was behind it

-> No sign of release post class



Implication for our Solution:

-> "Creative break app" alone isn't new enough, so lead with what differs: silly stakes, no score, maybe even private

-> Dazzle's missing directions echo our serious-prompt freeze, meaning a prompt should be startable in seconds of receiving

Dazzle

CS 147, Au 2015

What Works

-> “Casual, effortless” branding helps people get into taking BeReals every day without self-consciousness

-> Includes notifications when friends post BeReals so a person goes back to an app to check them

-> Posited on social consciousness as an incentive since you can only see other people’s BeReals if you post your own

-> Gallery of past BeReals

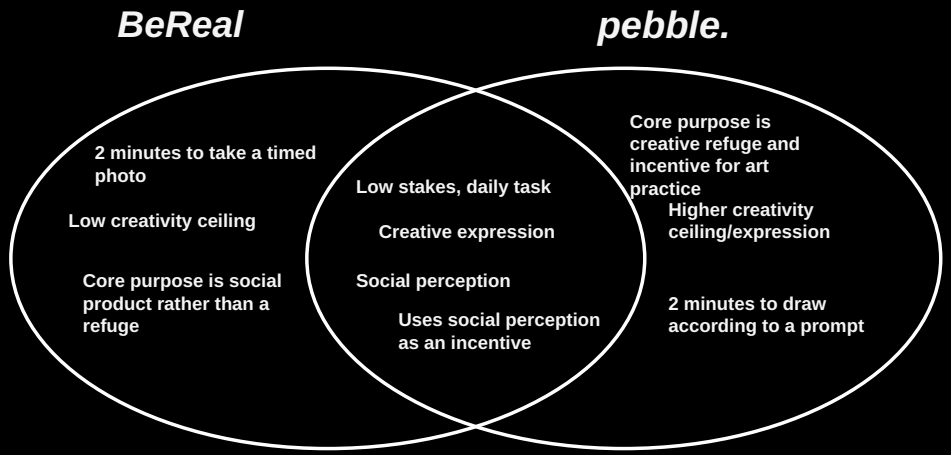
What Doesn’t Work

-> Requires other people/not a solo activity

-> Low creativity ceiling and a “one and done” kind of deal for a day

-> Streaks have become the main incentive for daily posting/engagement

-> (Less important) bad financial model



Implication for our Solution:

-> We want to honor a *frictionless* start (beginner-friendly UX)

-> Intentional replacement of what pulls people back to the app: maintain a sharing vibe *without social pressure*

-> Incentivize via *milestones* vs streaks to reduce stress on user (keep pebble a refuge rather than a stressful hobby)

BeReal

BeReal.

https://bereal.com/

Values in Design

Direct Stakeholders

1

Busy working adults and students

Core Users.
Gain a 3 minute refuge; risk one more ping to keep up with/break their flow

2

Hobbyists and beginners who freeze at self-judgment

Gain a low bar to start; risk silly framing reading as mockery of real effort

3

Prompt writers and reviewers

Their sense of humor sets what counts as “silly” for everyone

4

Users with motor/visual impairments **(excluded)**

Locked out of a drawing-first, screen-first design

5

Shift and hourly workers **(excluded)**

Breaks are scheduled and phone use may be banned, so the product assumes a freedom they may lack

Indirect Stakeholders

1

Friends & family

They are only involved if the user chooses to share
Can be inspired to join

2

Professional artists and art teachers

They are only involved if the user chooses to share
Can be inspired to join

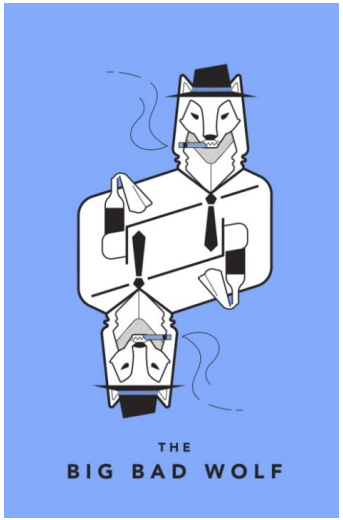
3

AI and data companies

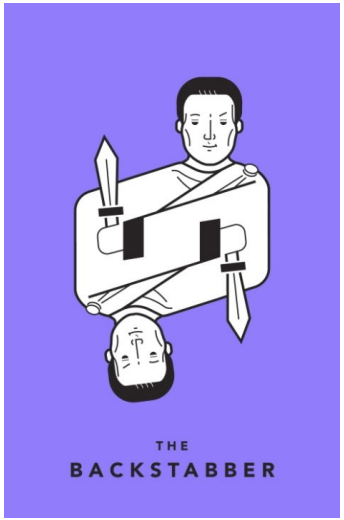
Stored drawings are potential training data

Tarot Cards of Tech:

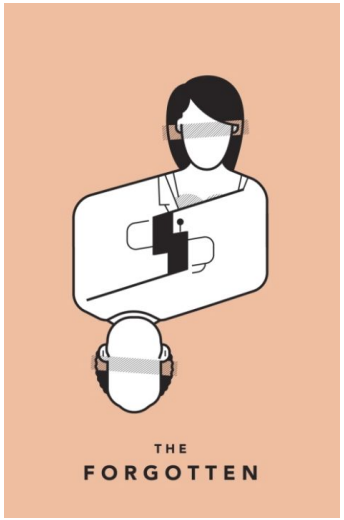
The Big Bad Wolf



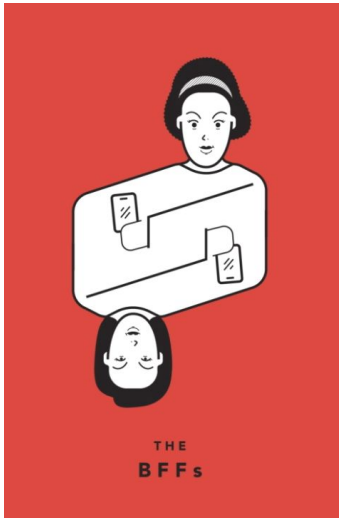
The Backstabber



The BFFs



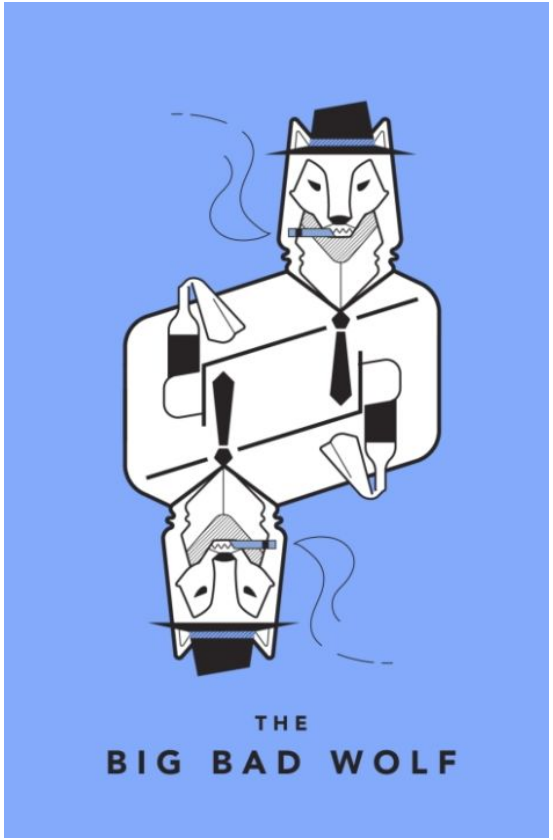
The Forgotten



https://tarotcardsoftech.artefactgroup.com/

The Big Bad Wolf

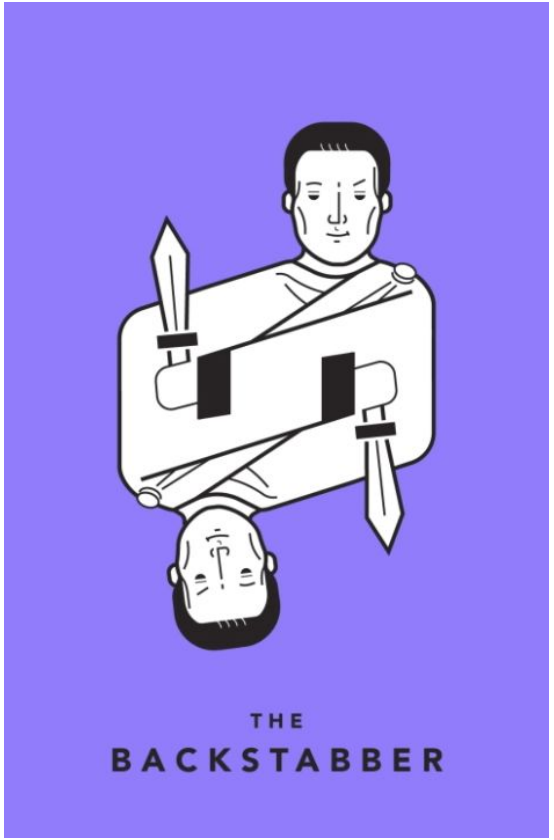
- **Value tension:** connection vs. safety. Sharing a silly drawing with a friend or the public is a real joy users may ask for; it is the attack surface at the same time
- The moment drawings can be shared, a bad actor can draw inappropriate pictures or target/involve other people without consent and pass them around.
- **Subgroup at risk:** people mocked in workplaces and schools, where caricatures already circulate in group chats; younger users if the app spreads beyond its intended adult audience
- **Overlooked stakeholder:** people who end up appearing in the drawings; they never use the app and never agreed to be in it.
- **How we would address it:**
    - Prompts never name or invite drawing a real person
    - No public feed, profiles, or comments. If sharing is a feature, it goes to chosen, consented friends/people, and there is no option to reshare
    - Report and block on anything shared
    - Age rating that matches our adult audience, or include a censored view for minors



https://tarotcardsoftech.artefactgroup.com/

The Backstabber

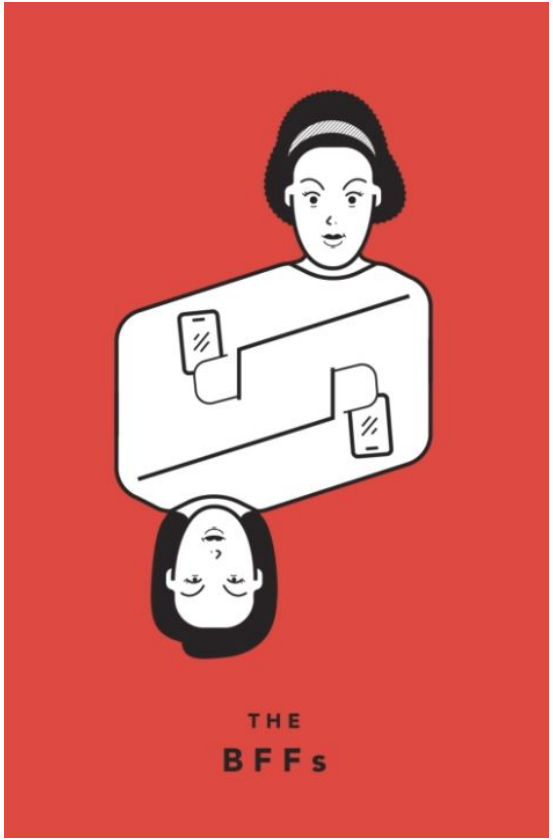
- **Value tension**: privacy vs. features and revenue. Cloud sync, look-back galleries, and analytics are useful, and each one needs stored data
- Whole promise is that nothing counts, so any sign that something is being counted or kept breaks it
- **Implication 1:**
    - AI training. If drawings sync to a server, they become possible training data. For a product for this specific project and studio theme, that would be considered the worst betrayal.
- **Implication 2:**
    - Workplace visibility. If the product is sold to companies as a wellness perk, managers would want usage reports. This can turn the refuge into an aspect of surveillance
- **Subgroup at risk**: artists already wary of AI scraping; employees in workplaces that monitor devices or time
- **Overlooked stakeholders**: AI companies and data buyers, and employers as customers, not just bystanders
- **How we would address it:**
    - Drawings stay on the device by default, no account needed to use the app
    - A plain-language promise written into the terms: drawings never sold or used to train AI
    - No employer dashboards, and never individual usage data to an employer
    - A one-tap ‘delete everything’ button, and no analytics



https://tarotcardsoftech.artefactgroup.com/

The BFFs

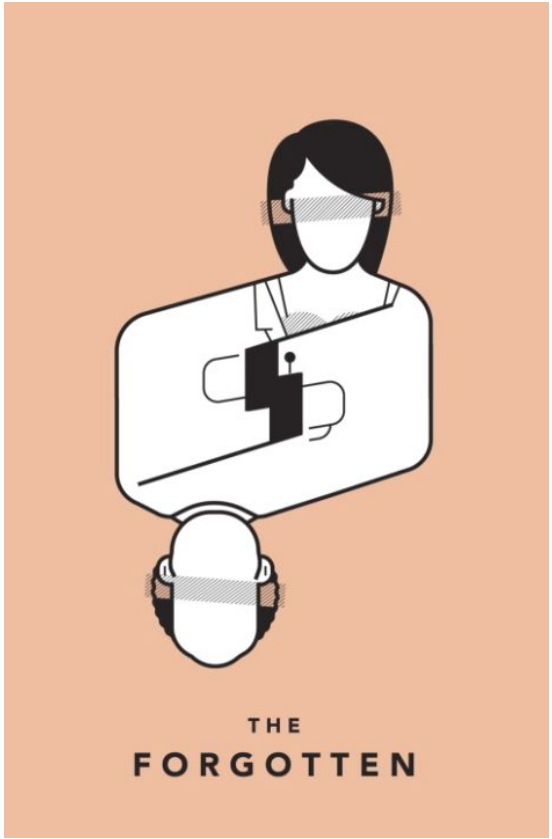
- **Value tension:** Social app versus app of comparison like standard social media. At what point does sharing one's work make them more insecure of what they've created?
- **Enhance:**
  - People can laugh at each other's silly drawings and they will be more incentivized to complete their drawings so they can see their friends' drawing of that day
  - In most friendships (qualitatively and from the team), people do not draw or create creative artifacts for each other often so this can help people see a more concretely creative side of their friends
- **Detract:**
  - People could start comparing their own doodles/unserious/silly drawings with each other and either feel like they are being too serious or not serious enough
  - When one friend stops drawing/uninstalls the app, the other friends will probably also start slowly stop using the app
- The product does not fill or change a role previously filled by a person but it might take away from the more serendipitous aspect of people drawing things for each other (since this manufactures that serendipity) but this is a very niche point



https://tarotcardsoftech.artefactgroup.com/

The Forgotten

- **Value tension:** Popularity of creativity form versus accessibility. Drawing is visual creativity and art is an easy way for users to convey emotions; however, this means that users with visual impairments can't access the product unless they have their own solutions to perceiving and creating visual media
- **Current user base**: people who don't necessarily work in creative industries, but want to upkeep their creative skills
- **Whose perspectives are missing?**
    - People with visual disabilities: our product is mostly visual-based, especially with the current focus on digital drawing
    - People with physical mobility disabilities
    - We are currently thinking about writers and digital artists, and so other forms of creativity and art are currently excluded: music, painting, sculptors, etc.
- **If the opposite of our user base was true:**
    - Everyone was visually impaired:
        - Then, probably, the main creativity form of our app would be something verbal or textual
    - People who have a lot of time to pursue creativity:
        - Might not see a use for our product
        - The three-minute timer isn't long enough to fully finish something they started–maybe they want to continue to work on it but now cannot
    - Social platform
        - People can be motivated by others' work



https://tarotcardsoftech.artefactgroup.com/

Tasks

Simple

Moderate

Complex

Timestamp: [0:51]

Simple: take a quick creative **break** outside of work

100% of users will need to complete this task (unless they delete the app immediately after downloading)

Every interviewee from A1 and A2 mentioned that creativity required dedicated, set-aside time

Users will need to intentionally engage in the break in order to move on to the next tasks

Quick creative break implies no time to “perfect” one’s drawing: **imperfection is encouraged**

Timestamp: [1:15]

Simple: get a silly prompt and **start drawing**

100% of users will need to complete this task (unless they delete the app immediately after downloading)

Drawing is the key function of the app; the rest of it is posited upon the user completing a daily drawing and this common task leads onto medium tasks

The silly prompt is meant to allow the user to be **creatively imperfect** and be less critical about their drawing, as we saw from our experience prototypes in A2

Timestamp: [01:06]

Moderate: make room for creativity in your week on **your own terms**

Not all users will engage in the app daily, but if they intentionally set aside time on their own terms then they will be able to engage with the app

Users must decide what time is dedicated to work versus what time they can dedicate to this app (on a weekday basis rather than a weekend basis)

Making room for creativity depends on the week and the user's needs; they have room to have **imperfect weeks** (supplemented by milestones vs. streaks in the next medium task)

[second half of video, no specific scene]

Moderate: reach **mile-“stones"**

Not all users will complete their tasks daily/in a streak system (especially because it puts a stress on the user)

Instead, the user is incentivized to reach milestones (# of drawings completed) to draw for as many days as possible and build their gallery

Milestones **allow for imperfections** (days where a user forgets to draw), streaks do not; milestones are not dependent on quality of drawings, so **imperfect drawings are more than sufficient**

[second half of video, no specific scene]

Complex: keep your creative practice alive **through a busy stretch**

Power users (~10%) will prioritize their creative refuge over a busy week/maintain consistent practice when there is high friction in doing so

Requires substantially more intentionality from the user to dedicate to the task and daily creativity of practice

Busy = no time for perfection; just get something done, where **imperfection is implied and even preferred**

Timestamp: [01:37]

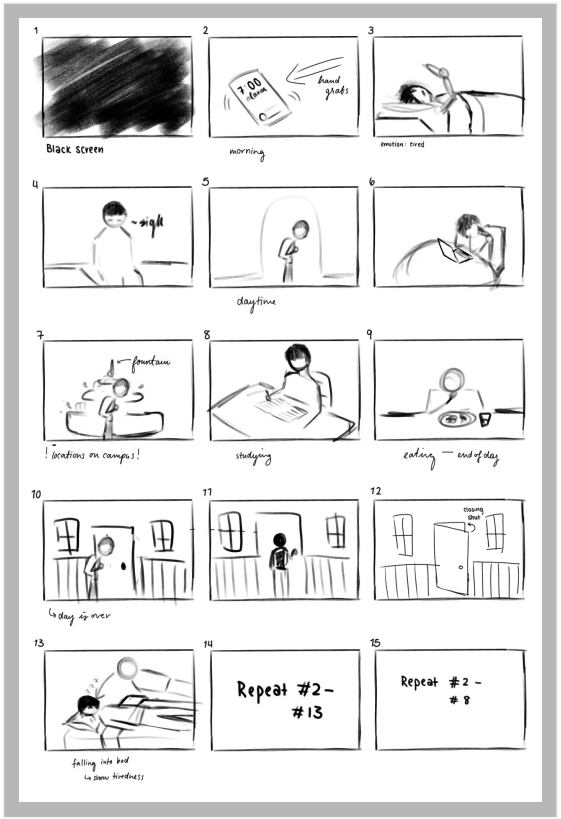
Complex: **inviting friends** to the app and seeing each other's drawings

Power users (~10%) will go out of their way to invite friends so they can look at their daily drawing for each prompt

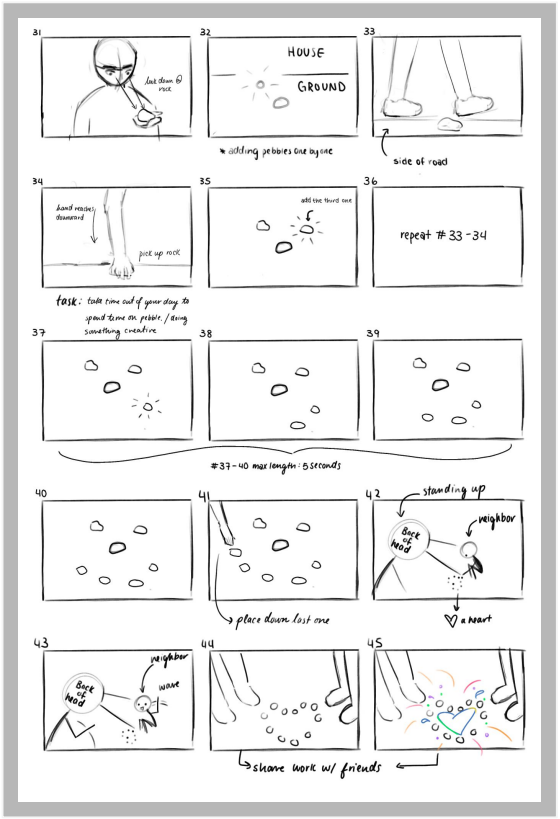
Introduces a social aspect to the app by including users' real friends and relationships, puts more at stake on the user

Harold (A2) stated "producing music by yourself sucks"; sharing art with others allows users to be in community and **be comfortable in/appreciate their shared imperfection**

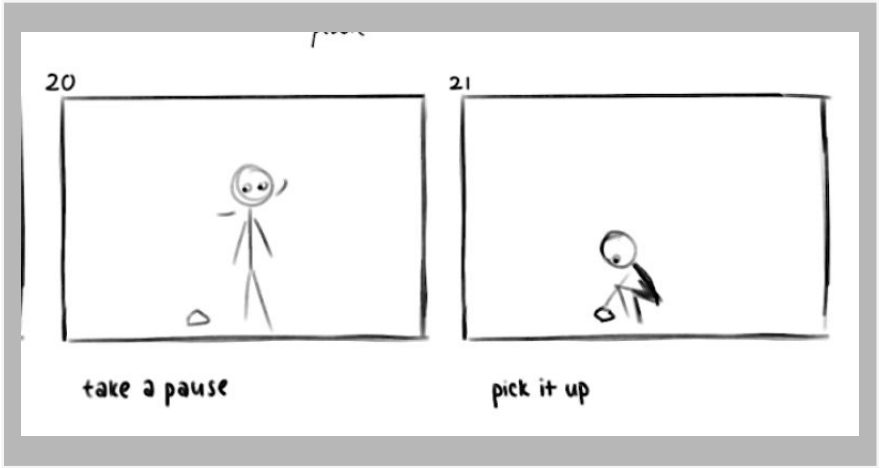
Storyboard

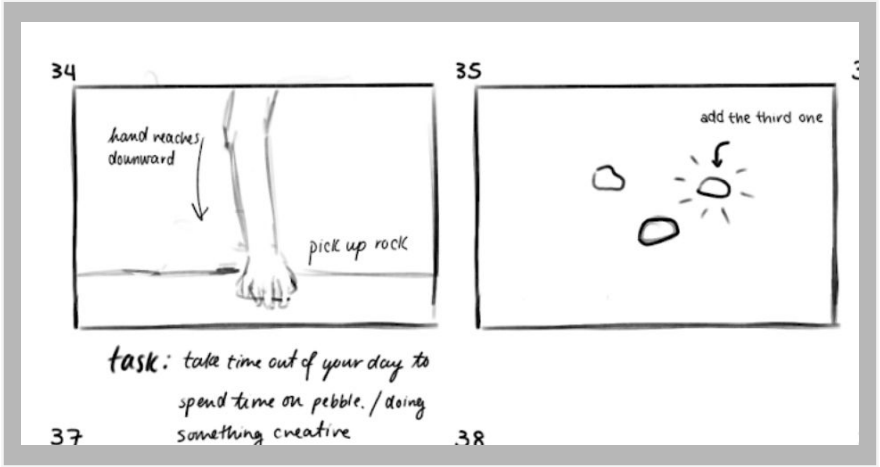

1
Black screen
2
7:00 alarm
hand grabs
morning
3
emotion: tired
4
sigh
5
daytime
6
7
fountain
! locations on campus !
8
studying
9
eating — end of day
10
↳ day is over
11
12
closing door
13
falling into bed
↳ show tiredness
14
Repeat #2 - #13
15
Repeat #2 - #8


16
17
18
pebble
* trip over pebble *
19
20
21
* a forced stop of your day: a reminder to take a break
take a pause
pick it up
22
23
24
turn head
look at phone
25
HOUSE
26
27
enter house
28
29
30
* stop to look


31
last down @ rock
32
HOUSE
GROUND
* adding pebbles one by one
33
side of road
34
hand reaches downward
pick up rock
35
add the fourth one
36
repeat #33-34
task: take time out of your day to spend time on pebble / doing something creative
37
38
39
#37-40 max length: 5 seconds
40
41
place down last one
42
standing up
neighbor
Back of Head
♡ = heart
43
neighbor
Back of Head
wave
44
45
share work w/ friends

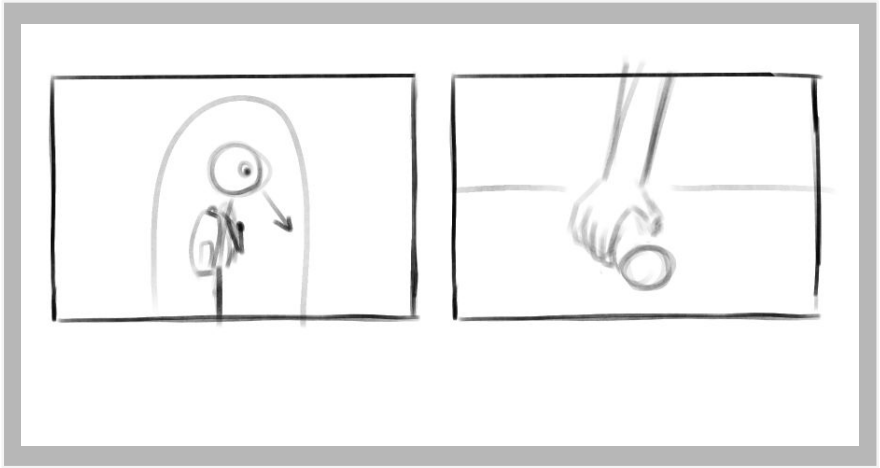
Task: take a quick creative break [0:51]

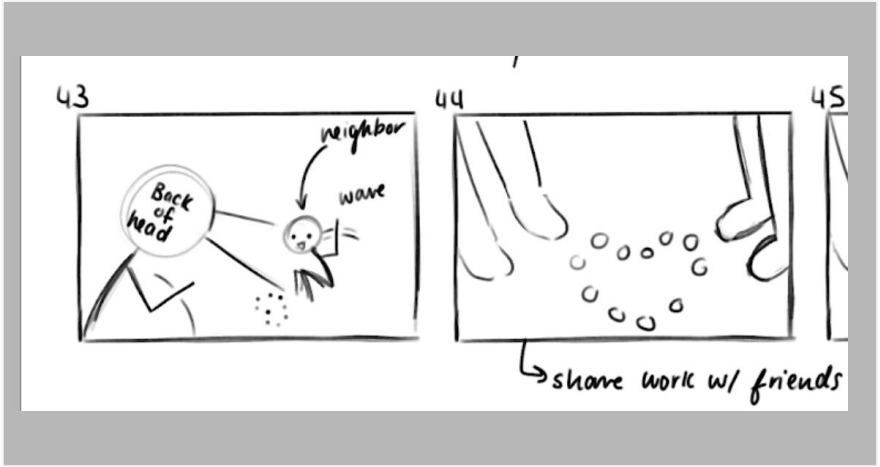




Task: start drawing [1:15]

Task: make room for creativity
[1:06]





Task: share w/ friends
[1:37]

Video link



Appendix

1



Black screen

2



morning

3



emotion: tired

4



5



daytime

6



7



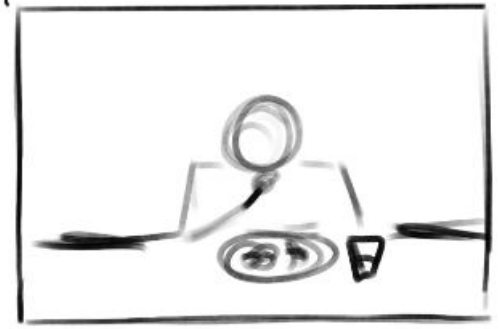
! locations on campus !

8



studying

9



eating — end of day

10

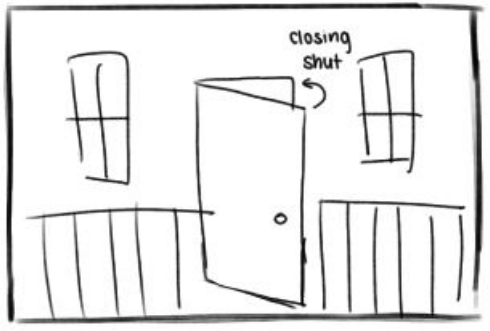


↳ day is over

11



12



13



falling into bed
↳ show tiredness

14

Repeat #2-
#13

15

Repeat #2 -
#8

16



17



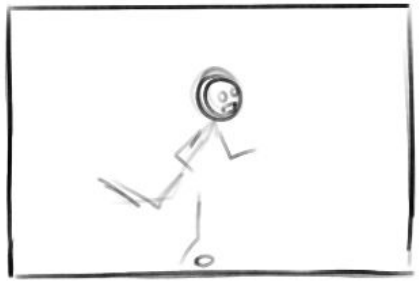
pebble

18



* trip over pebble *

19



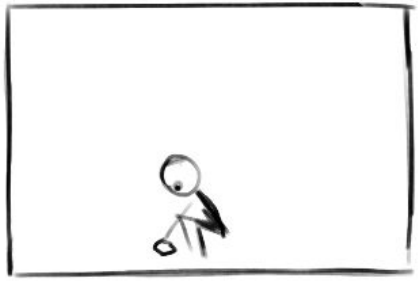
* a forced stop of your day: a reminder to take a break

20



take a pause

21



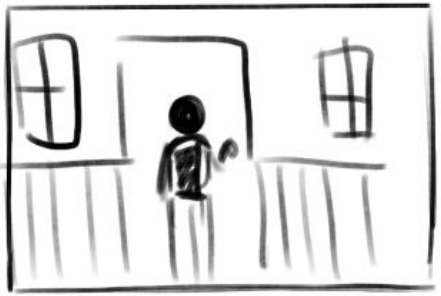
pick it up

22

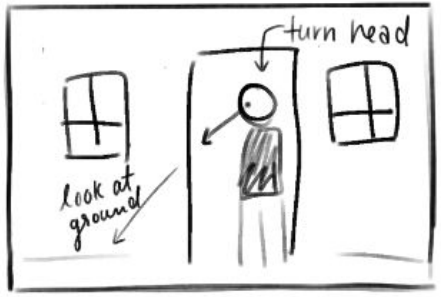
reminder to take a break



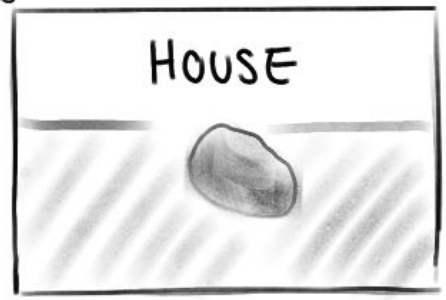
23



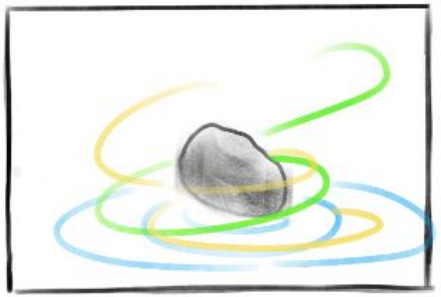
24



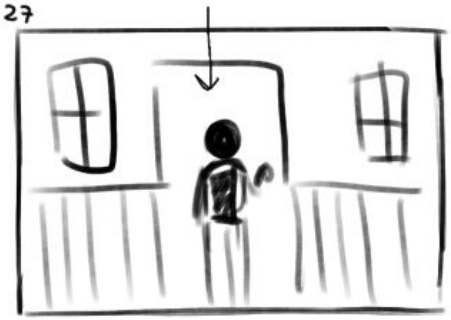
25



26



27



28



29



30

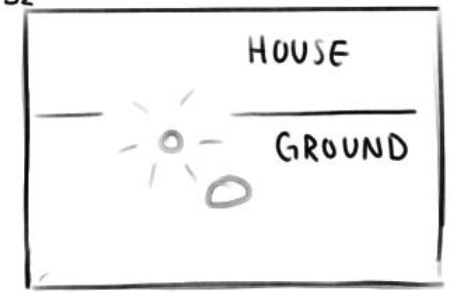


* Stop to look

31



32



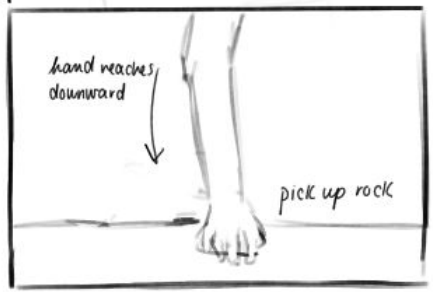
* adding pebbles one by one

33



side of road

34



35



36

repeat # 33 - 34

task: take time out of your day to spend time on pebble. / doing something creative

37

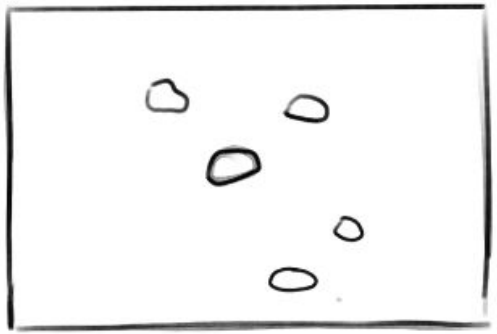
38

39

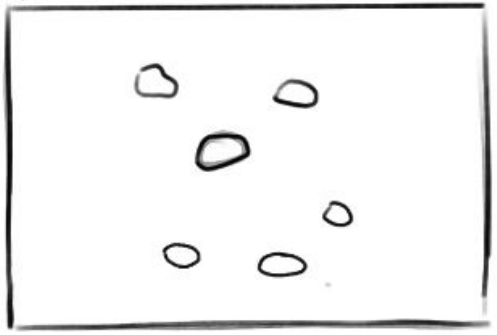
37 something creative



38

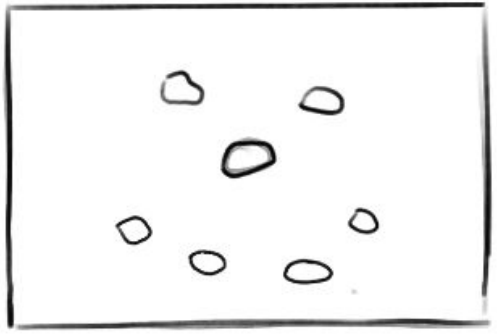


39

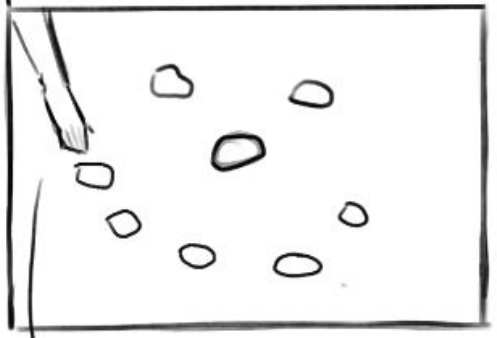


#37-40 max length: 5 seconds

40

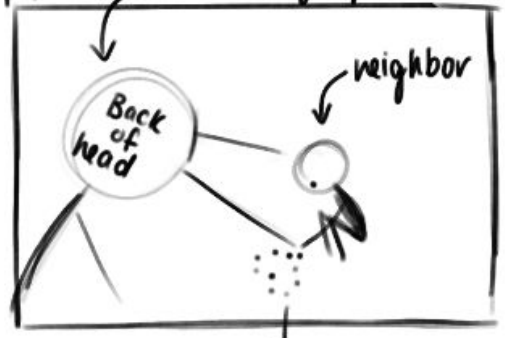


41

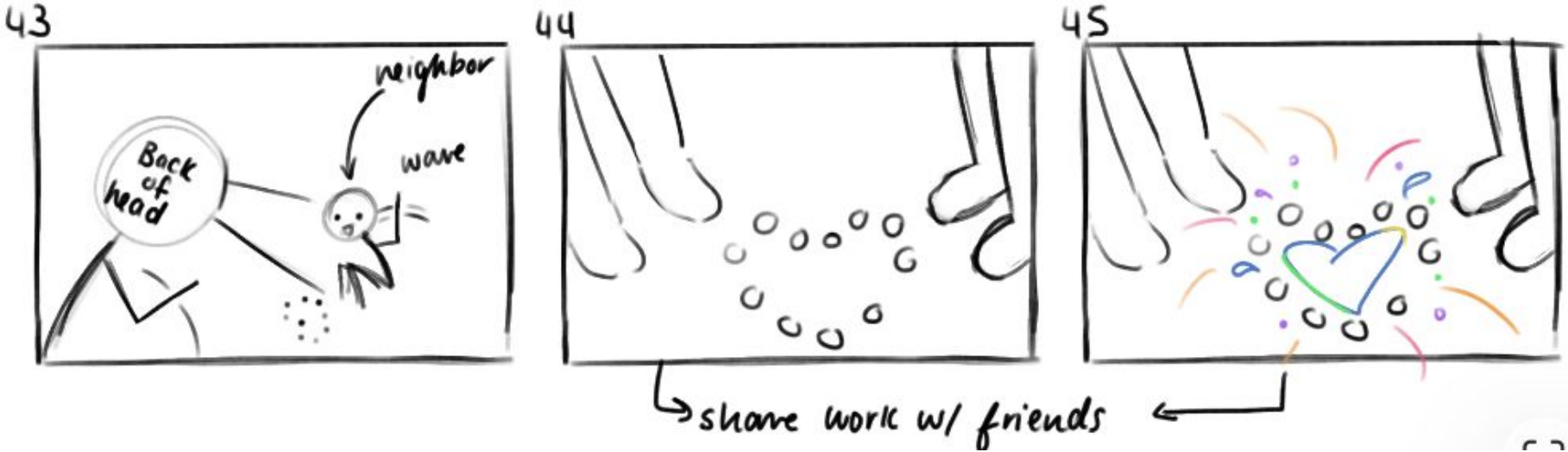


place down last one

42 standing up



a heart


43
neighbor
wave
Back of head
44
45
share work w/ friends